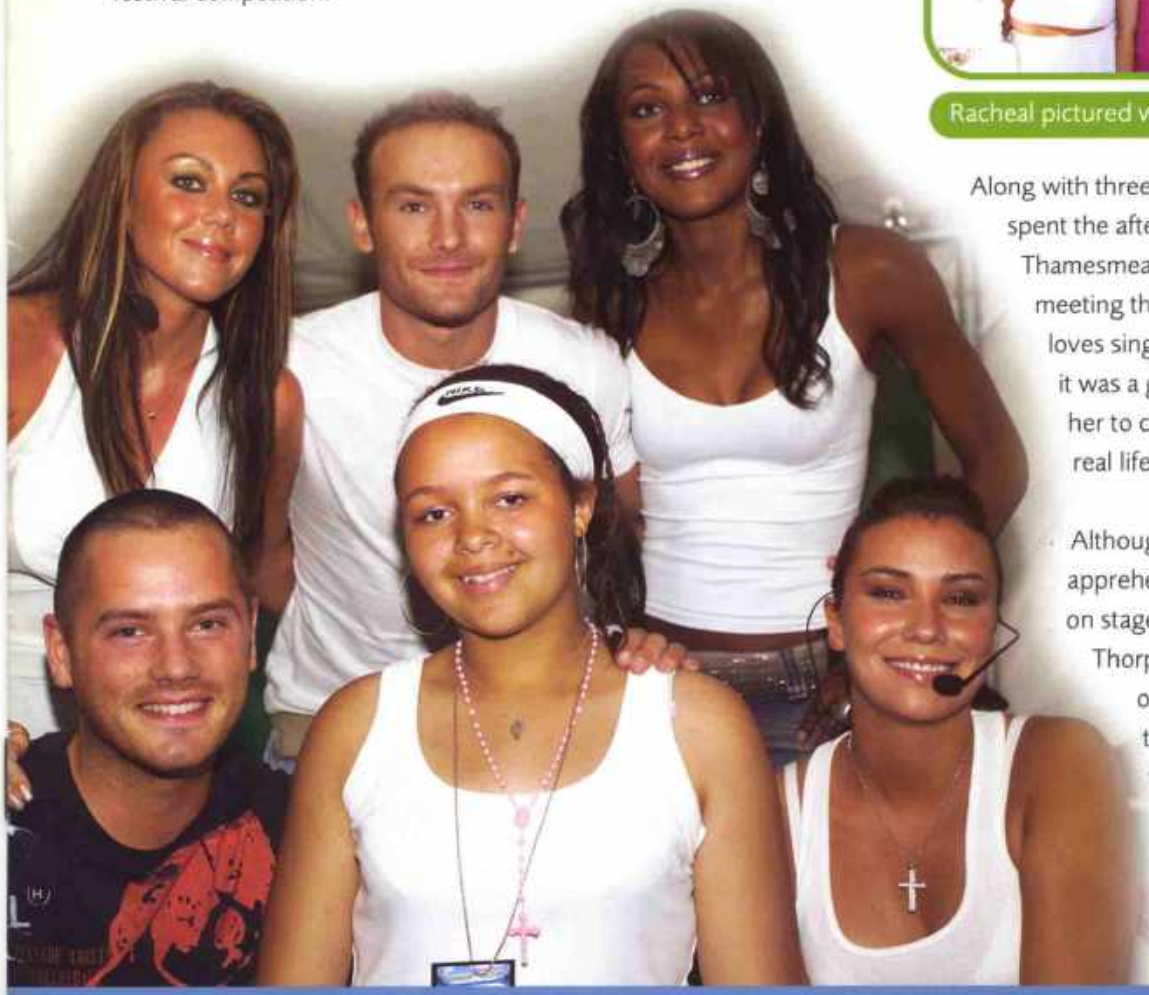
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YOUR COMMUNITY MAGAZINE
ISSUE 7
AUGUST 05

Stars in their eyes

It was a day 13 year old Racheal Prime from Thamesmead won't forget for a long time. With autographs from Liberty X, photographs with Phixx and a chance to chat to Javine, Racheal was the lucky winner of our festival competition.



Racheal pictured with Liberty X and Javine



Along with three friends, Racheal spent the afternoon of the Trust Thamesmead Festival backstage meeting the stars. Racheal loves singing and dancing and it was a great opportunity for her to catch up with some real life celebrities.

Although a little apprehensive when invited on stage by compere Danny Thorpe, the girls overcame their nerves to tell the crowd who their favourite band member was. A clear winner emerged with Tony topping the list.

BEHIND THE SCENES
How Team Gallions transformed Birchmere Park.

DANCING IN THE CITY
Thamesmead Dancers reach final.

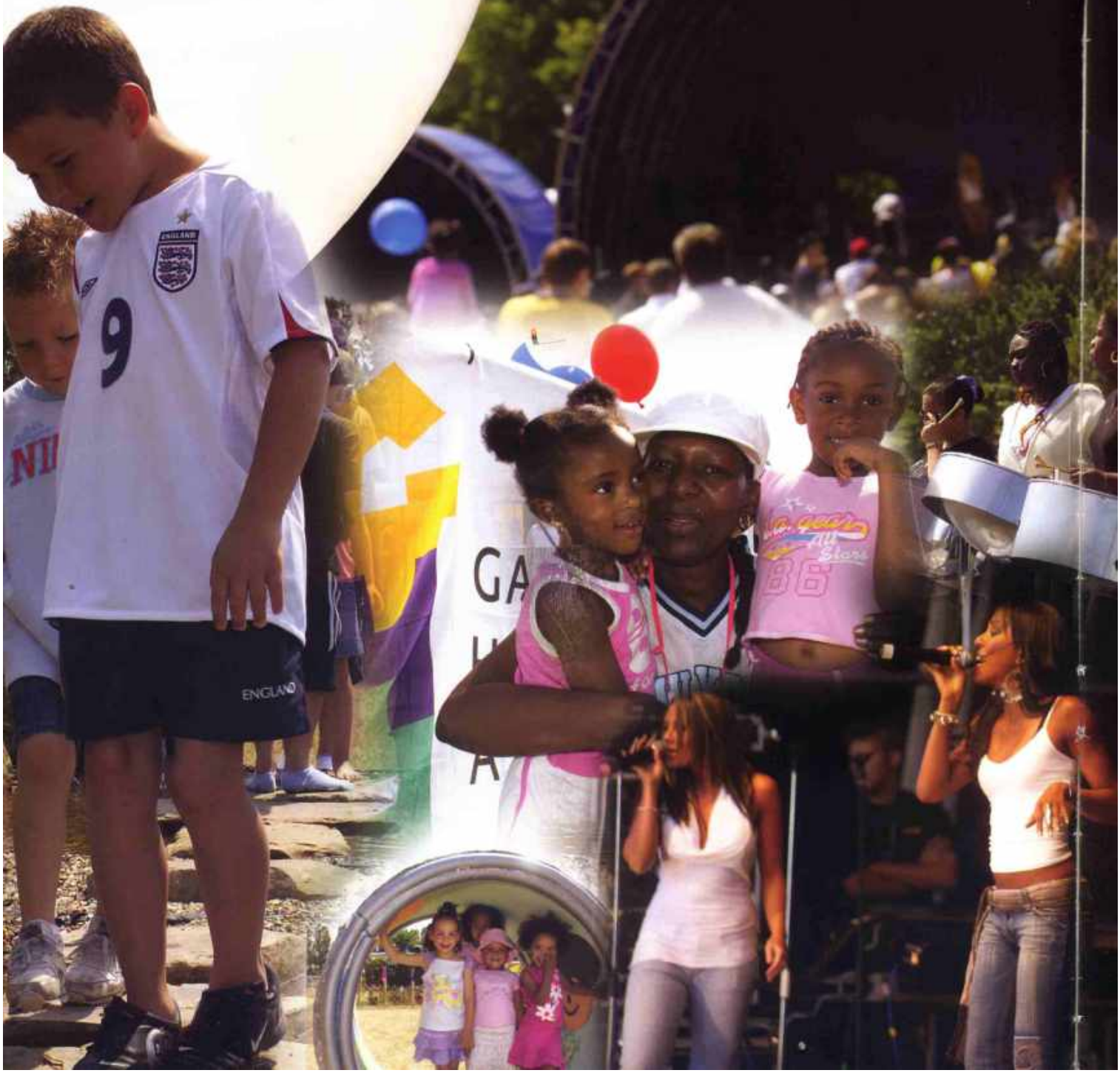
SECURITY FOR YOUR HOME
Improving safety in homes.

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

Freephone: 0800 838481
www.gallionsha.co.uk



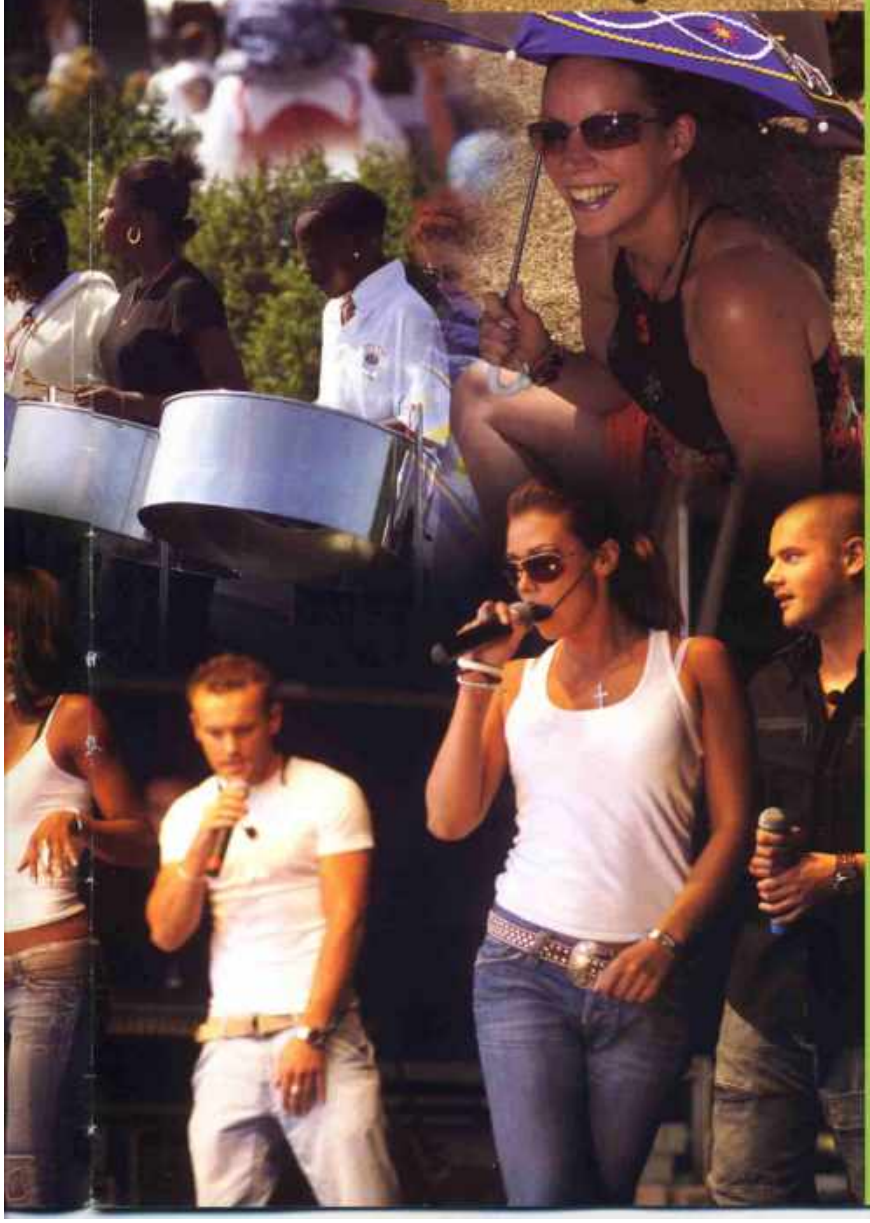












ISSUE #7

editorial

Festival Fun

A great time was had by all at the Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival. All the planning and hard work was well worth the effort as the day got off to a flying start.

With all the chart topping acts, local perfomers and fun fair, the day was enhanced further by brilliant sunshine. There was a real community spirit and it was a great day for young and old alike as you can tell from our photo montage.

If you have any stories about your own summer and community events that everyone can enjoy please call the Thamesview Team on 0208 320 3414.

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Pictures from the day

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Summer fun in Thamesmead

6 **Stepping Out**
Fitness not far from your doorstep

9 **Building Success**
Planned maintenance coming your way

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Keep ahead of the times



Behind the scenes

On 16th July Birchmere Park was transformed from a quiet, peaceful park with lovely mature trees and a tranquil lake into a rocking arena for a great family day out. While bouncy castles, donkey rides and merry-go-rounds kept the toddlers happy hundreds of older children enjoyed hurtling through the air on terrifying, gravity-defying fairground rides. Enough thrills and spills to last until next summer.
Team Gallions played a vital role in holding the whole event together and here they talk us through their 15-hour day.

26 members of Team Gallions arrived for duty at Birchmere Park at 7am. We had a number of very different roles to carry out that day – from putting together the under fives play zone to providing stewards and security around the park. We divided into teams and dived straight in.

At 7.15 we were putting up fences and signs, fixing chairs on stage and burying what seemed like hundreds of miles of cabling. While we were busy digging, sticking and hammering the donkeys and hens for the children's play area arrived and needed some tender loving care to help them settle in. Some one was definitely doing a great job as the hens made themselves at home and laid four eggs during the day! The hens were a huge hit with the children with one little boy simply staring at them for a full 20 minutes – he was fascinated.

The sand pit and the pool were always going to be popular and the children's faces just lit up as they saw the potential for real fun in the sun. One mum even asked if her daughter could keep one of our foil sunflowers *"to remind her of a lovely day"*.

For one youngster the heat and excitement was too much and he took himself for a little lie down in one of the crawl through pipes. I don't suppose he got much rest with all the other children keen to scramble through the pipes.

With some 15,000 people trampling through the park in temperatures of up to 30 degrees it was absolutely essential that we had in place a seamless litter collection service. Team Gallions staff were primed to remove any litter lying around and our plan worked perfectly. A total of 8 tons of rubbish was removed from the park so it came as no surprise that Team Gallions drank 100 litres of water during the day.
It was an enormous task but everyone worked so hard to make it a great success.

Acting also as stewards for the day, Team Gallions ensured the safety and security of everyone in the park.

It was a great day for everyone involved and 700 hours of preparation and clean up really paid off.
A big thank you to Team Gallions for making the day such a great success.



Dancing in the city



Fifteen young street dancers from Thamesmead have danced their way right into the finals of a competition in Hammersmith Apollo. The street dancing team was first formed three years ago as part of the Youth Awareness Programme (YAP) based at Harrow Manor Way. The project was so popular and the children so enthusiastic that when funding ended everyone agreed that the dancing should go on. Myztikal was formed and today it attracts an average of 40 children every week.

Choreographer Marcus Donaldson puts them through their paces while youth leader Joanne Bernard supervises the children and ferries them to and fro when necessary. Not all of the children participate and some just come along to enjoy the atmosphere. Joanne says: *"It's a real family atmosphere where the children can relax and talk about their day and their lives. While some start by sitting on the sidelines, most can't resist and will eventually join in the dancing."*

None of Myztikal's staff get paid for their time and rely on the goodwill of the community to keep the group going. The Church of the Cross in Lensbury Way and the Emmanuel Church provide both premises and support to the enthusiastic young dancers. As Myztikal wowed the crowd at the Trust Thamesmead Festival last month it is clear that this talented bunch of youngsters are determined to enjoy the spotlight.

From Wardens to Gardeners





Two of Gallions' neighbourhood wardens recently dropped their radios and picked up a shovel and spade to help out a couple of residents facing a gardening nightmare. Wendy Mason tells us what happened.

Maureen was delighted when she moved into a ground floor flat with a garden. Unfortunately, her delight was short lived as it soon became clear that an overgrown thorn hedge had overtaken her garden. Not only was the light blocked out, such was the size of the hedge that there was very little garden left for Maureen to enjoy. The hedge was too big for her cut down on her own, so our wardens Phil and Loretta came to Maureen's rescue. After three hours of hard work and another pair of hands in the form of supervisor Frank, Phil and Loretta finally overcame the hedge and cleared the garden. Thanks to the Gallions team Maureen is now enjoying the long, hot summer in the luxury of her garden. Spurred on by their success the Wardens decided to help Stan revamp his balcony.

Once again Phil and Loretta donned their gardening gear and gave Stan's balcony a fantastic facelift. Stan too is now sitting out on his balcony enjoying the fresh air. Phil and Loretta (still suffering from the scratches) said *"it is great to see them enjoying themselves and it is amazing how a small token helps to improve someone's quality of life so much"*.



Stepping Out

Want to walk your way to health? Walking is a great way to get that important exercise we all need every day - all you need is a comfortable pair of shoes!

As well as all the fantastic parks and lakes around Thamesmead for taking short walks, you can also join the Green Chain Walk, a network of paths which runs from Thamesmead to areas all over southeast London. It means you can decide how far you want to walk and where by following the signs.

To help people get started or for those of you who don't want to walk alone, Bexley Care Trust has set up some organised walks around Bexley:

Mondays at 11.00am in Franks Park, Belvedere

Meet at the Fox House Road entrance (off Erith Road, Belvedere) at 11.00am for a 30-minute circular walk. Franks Park consists of mature woodland and parkland. The paths can be uneven in places and muddy when wet. There are steep inclines in a couple of places.

Tuesdays at 10.30am in The Glade, Sidcup

Meet at Marlowe House, Sidcup at 10.30am for a 30-minute circular walk around The Glade (sometimes referred to as Lamorbey Park). This walk is on tarmac or paved paths throughout and mainly on the flat with minor inclines in a couple of places. An excellent starting walk for beginners and suitable for all (including buggies).

Wednesdays at 10.30am across Foots Cray Meadows

Meet at Parsonage Lane Bus Stop by Leafield Lane at 10.30am for a 60-minute circular walk across Foots Cray Meadows. A stunning walk across beautiful woodland and along the riverside. Predominantly walking on the flat on grassland and trodden paths throughout. Can be muddy when wet (Wellington boots recommended).

For further information please contact Lynda Stevens at Bexley Care Trust on 020 8298 6289.

Skip the exercise!

The skipping craze is back and hitting schools all over London, from skipping competitions to sports day events and even a crack at a world record. To those of you who have distant memories of skipping in the playground, you'll know its healthy, cheap and just as important – lots of fun. It's great for kids but us adults have no excuse to sit out - skipping improves strength, stamina, agility and co-ordination so why not give it a try!





Do you want to stop smoking?

Do you want to give up smoking but know you can't do it alone? We've found two groups that can give you advice and help in giving up the fags for good.

Greenwich Stop Smoking Service

Greenwich Stop Smoking Service will run a 7-week support group to help smokers quit from Wednesday 21st September to Wednesday 2nd November at 1.00 - 2.00pm in the Jubilee Room at Gallions Community Resource Centre, Harrow Manor Way, SE2 9XH. The group will provide friendly support and advice on how to manage withdrawal symptoms, strategies on how to cope without cigarettes and Nicotine Replacement Therapy and Zyban on prescription. All are welcome. For further information or to book a place on the group, please call Jill Day at Greenwich Stop Smoking Service on 020 8293 6979.

Bexley Stop Smoking Service

Bexley Stop Smoking Service also run a 6 week stop smoking clinic during the daytime, evening and weekends at Queen Mary's Hospital, Sidcup and Erith Hospital. You can also get one to one support through your GP and some local pharmacists. For more information call 020 8298 6161.

ASB HOTLINE

The anti social behaviour hotline gives you the opportunity to report disruptive or nuisance behaviour. It is an automated system and you will reach a recorded message asking for details of the problem. The hotline is monitored and your message will be forwarded to the appropriate authorities. We want to stamp out anti-social behaviour and we need your help to do it. (Please note that our hotline is simply there to record the details of your complaint - it is not a responsive service and should not be used in an emergency situation.)





SAFETY FIRST FOR RESIDENTS

Bexley's Community Safety Action Zone and Victim Support have teamed up to offer Gallions residents (within the Bexley borough only) FREE security improvements to their homes.

The new security which will be fitted to your existing front door by a trained carpenter include:

- **new 5 lever mortice 'Chubb' lock and keep**
- **new barrel for an existing lock**
- **heavy duty door chain that can be secured when residents are out**
- **wide-angled door viewer to see who's calling**

If you are interested all you need to do is call Gallions Customer Contact Team on 0800 838481, who will pass on your details to Bexley Council for the new security items to be fitted completely free of charge.

12 Months Home Contents Insurance from only £3.07 per fortnight.

No Quote Required
Premiums Shown Below

* For tenants aged over 60 premiums start from just £2.23 per fortnight

Pay As You Go Home Contents Insurance

(a special scheme for residents of Gallions Housing Association, in association with Jardine Lloyd Thompson Tenant Risks)

Sum Insured	Fortnightly Cost	Monthly Cost	Annual Cost
*£6,000	£2.23	£3.64	£43.68
£9,000	£3.07	£5.46	£65.52
£10,000	£3.35	£6.07	£72.80
£12,000	£3.91	£7.28	£87.36
£15,000	£4.75	£9.10	£109.20
£20,000	£6.15	£12.13	£145.60

*only available for applicants over the age of 60

- Low cost insurance from only £65.52 (or £43.68 if you are aged over 60)
- Paid fortnightly at any post office, monthly by Direct Debit or annually by cheque/Postal Order – see premiums in the table opposite
- All post codes included at no additional cost
- No security requirements
- No long term commitment – you literally 'pay as you go'

Sums insured are available from £6,000 to £30,000; all premiums, terms and conditions are stated within a free information pack.

In association with

JARDINE LLOYD THOMPSON Tenant Risks

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

For more information please call:

0845 4082033

Jardine Lloyd Thompson Tenant Risks is a division of JLT Corporate Risks Limited. Lloyd's Broker. Authorised and Regulated by the Financial Services Authority. A member of the Jardine Lloyd Thompson Group. Registered Office: 6 Crutched Friars, London EC3N 2PH. Registered in England No 00338645. VAT No. 244 2321 96

one to one

Building Success



Terry Bird may only have been at Gallions for four months but he has already made clear how he wants to roll out the association's planned maintenance programme. After training as a quantity surveyor Terry moved in to Building Surveying and is a member of the Chartered Institute of Building. With 25 years' experience behind him, he is more than capable of delivering real results.

One thing that Terry is clear on is that it is absolutely vital to ensure that residents needs are met. Coming from this starting point Terry plans to adopt a *"whole house"* approach to the internal refurbishment of Thamesmead's homes. *"I am determined that we minimise the stress and disruption to people's lives and my aim is to streamline the process as far as possible. We will look at the wider picture and will carry out all works together. New kitchens, bathrooms, roofs and re-wiring will all happen at the same time."*

Logical as this may seem, work has not always been carried out in such a structured way and Terry was quick to spot the problems and take action to address them. He is currently in the middle of a comprehensive review of what work needs to be carried out, where and when. From the results of this review, key decisions will be taken and a timetable for action will be in place by the end of the year.

The next step for Terry is then to find a contractor to carry out the work. He says:

" To date we have used a number of different contractors to deliver different parts of the programme. I believe that we will get a much greater degree of predictability and consistency of service levels if we identify a contractor who is fully committed to the complete job."

Gallions' existing partners Axis have provided an outstanding service and the feedback from residents and members of the Gallions Resident Board has been very positive. Terry is quick to point out that there are no problems with the quality of work Axis has delivered. A strong procurement process is essential in identifying such an important strategic contractor. Terry also knows that to find the right partner it is vital to ask key stakeholders what they want. A procurement panel comprising Gallions officers and members of the Gallions Resident Board has been established to help evaluate and select a long-term contractor. Together a picture of what is needed is being painted and Terry is confident that an exceptional contractor will soon be identified.

"I see this an opportunity for the chosen contractor to really invest in the community. They must be fully customer-focused and must be committed to building a long-term professional partnership with Gallions."

Planning and preparation underpins every successful job and the refurbishment of some 5,500 homes is no different. As Terry begins to pull all the different strands together one thing becomes very clear – here is a man determined to provide his customers with the best product and service he can deliver.

LEASEHOLDERS LINE

Our weekly leaseholder sessions at the Tenants Resource Centre are your opportunity to come along and discuss any issues or concerns you may have as a homeowner. Please call Yinka Akinyemi or a member of the team on 0208 320 3424 to make an appointment. We no longer run our drop in sessions so do call and make an appointment beforehand.

News Review

Axis receive award for work within the community

Axis Europe PLC have won a national award for excellence in making a real and growing difference to the environment in which they work, including right here in Thamesmead. Axis have received the award for their work within the community including offering many local residents the opportunities of apprenticeship vacancies and work experience as well as community events and sports programmes for young people.

Post Office

As most of you will already know the new post office in the town centre, which was due to open last month, has not happened. We have been told this is due to delays within the post office. As yet we had not received a new opening date but we will keep you updated on any news.



Mutual Exchange Register

Our new initiative aimed at everyone currently on the transfer list is now up and running!

You can register your details on our property list to help you find a possible exchange.

All of the homes available for exchange are now on a full register. You can look through this at anytime in Gallions reception. To get more information about the scheme call our Customer Contact Centre on 0800 83 84 81 or visit Gallions reception.

Gallions' Annual Review 2004/05. Taking a look at what has happened over the past year, the new review will be available on our website www.gallionsha.co.uk from 3rd October 2005. If you would like a copy to be posted to you after this date, please contact Joy McKee on 0208 320 3414.

JOB OPPORTUNITIES

Immediate Start

Office Junior required in our Repairs and Maintenance Division, Crayford.

General administration duties, inputting of data, faxing, photocopying, processing invoices and filing. Tasks will include taking telephone calls, recording messages accurately and liaising with residents and trades people.

If you are interested please call Maria Northwood on 0207 564 2100 or send your CV to Maria.Northwood@axiseurope.com, fax:0207 564 2116 or by post to Maria Northwood, Human Resources, 145-149 Vauxhall Street, London, SE11 5RH.

No previous office experience necessary, just a confident approach working in a busy environment.

AXIS EUROPE PLC

QUALITY HOUSING SERVICES

The year Gallions celebrates its fifth anniversary. Over the years we have always relied on our residents to tell us what the neighbourhood wants. Your ideas are helping to shape our community where people want to live and work.

Mike Robinson tells us about winning the QHS award and what changes we have introduced to bring you a customer service that meets your needs.

Have you been asked about Gallions service lately? What did you have to say about the quality of services? It must have been good because your opinions have meant that Gallions has been awarded the QHS Certificate of Excellence, but what does this award mean to you as a Gallions customer? QHS stands for Quality Housing Services.

It is a mark of distinction designed specifically for housing associations. Your views have helped us score top marks in the QHS criteria of excellence.

Using 'mystery shoppers', telephone surveys, polls and on-site inspections QHS are able to paint a very clear picture of how Gallions operates. We always listen to what QHS have to say and we have made some big changes that have helped us win this award.

All Gallions staff have recently received intensive customer communication training to ensure a smooth and helpful service and we have changed our reception area to become more user friendly.

While the QHS Award shows that we are working hard to get our services just right, we need your help to keep moving things forward. So don't stop telling us how we are doing now and what we need to do to do it better.


Trident House

Special offer for Keyworkers!

Stamp duty paid*

Gallions has only 4 brand new 2 bedroom apartments available for keyworkers to purchase through the part buy, part rent scheme.

These fabulous apartments in Trident House, West Thamesmead start from just £76,500 for a 45% share. A subsidised rent is payable on the remainder. If you are a key worker and earn at least £24,000 you may qualify for one of these brand new homes.

To find out more about these homes or to enquire about your keyworker status call the sales team today on freephone 0800 731 4587.

*To qualify, purchasers must reserve a property by Saturday 20th August and complete within 6 weeks. Stamp duty will be paid on % share purchased.

www.gallionsha.co.uk e-mail: homes@gallionsha.co.uk

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION



GALLIONS FREEPHONE 0800 83 84 81

Gallions Residents' Board and Gallions Housing Association 6th Annual

housing & community fair



Free BBQ Free prize draw
– win a TV, video, Hi-Fi and kiddie's toys

Saturday 17 September 2005
12noon – 4pm

Gallions Housing Association Grounds
Harrow Manor Way
London SE2 9XH (parking)

- Exhibitions
- Stalls
- Bouncy Castle
- Henna Painting
- Face Painting
- Football Games
- Under 5's Play Area
- Children's Entertainers

GRB

Celebrating Diversity in Thamesmead

Come and meet the people who provide your services

For further information call Martin Hogan on **020 8320 3462**

getinvolved@gallionsha.co.uk

business for neighbourhoods

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

QVS

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾，請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

August 05

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐

(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Contact us

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London
SE2 9XH

For all enquiries please contact the
Customer Response Centre
0800 83 84 81
It's a freephone number that you can use to book services, repairs or for any other enquiries.

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION